

60-Day Practitioner Assessment

GovCon BD Upskilling Certification

Assessment Overview

- **Questions:** 20 multiple-choice (scenario-heavy)
- **Time Limit:** 45 minutes
- **Passing Score:** 75% (15 correct)
- **Format:** 80% scenario-based, 20% knowledge recall
- **Prerequisites:** Completion of 30-Day Foundation
- **Focus:** Advanced opportunity qualification, capture planning, stakeholder engagement, competitive analysis

Instructions:

This assessment tests your ability to apply BD concepts in realistic scenarios. Read each situation carefully before selecting your answer.

Section A: Advanced Opportunity Qualification (Questions 1-5)

Question 1 (Complex Scenario)

You've identified a \$50M IDIQ opportunity with the Army. Your company has relevant past performance but has never worked with this specific command. The RFP requires a Secret facility clearance (which you have) and three past performance references within the last 5 years. Your most relevant project ended 4 years ago. How should you qualify this opportunity?

- A. No-bid immediately—the risk is too high
- B. Green light—you meet all stated requirements
- C. Yellow flag—pursue but develop a strategy to strengthen the past performance gap through teaming or highlighting transferable experience
- D. Wait until the RFP is released to decide

Your Answer:

Question 2 (Scenario)

A Sources Sought notice asks for capability statements from small businesses for a network modernization project. The notice mentions the agency is considering both 8(a) sole-source and full-and-open competition. Your company is an 8(a) certified SDVOSB. What is your best response strategy?

- A. Submit a basic capability statement and wait
- B. Submit a detailed response emphasizing your 8(a) status and request a meeting to discuss sole-source potential
- C. Ignore it—Sources Sought notices rarely lead to contracts
- D. Ask a large business to prime the contract with you as a sub

Your Answer:

Question 3 (Analysis)

You're reviewing an opportunity using a Pwin (Probability of Win) framework. Which factor would MOST significantly reduce your Pwin score?

- A. The contract is 20% larger than your largest previous award
- B. You have no relationship with the customer and the RFP drops in 30 days
- C. A competitor has slightly more past performance references
- D. The work location is in a different state than your headquarters

Your Answer:

Question 4 (Scenario)

Your capture manager asks you to research a recompetete opportunity. The incumbent has held the contract for 8 years through multiple extensions. Customer satisfaction surveys show 85% satisfaction (good, not great). What opportunity signal does this present?

- A. Don't pursue—incumbents always win recompetes
- B. Strong opportunity—longevity plus “good not great” performance suggests customer may be open to alternatives
- C. Wait for the incumbent to protest, then pursue
- D. Only pursue if you can undercut their price by 30%

Your Answer:

Question 5 (Application)

You're building a bid/no-bid decision matrix. Which criteria should receive the HIGHEST weight in your scoring?

- A. Contract value
- B. Customer relationship and competitive position
- C. Proposal due date
- D. Number of competitors

Your Answer:

Section B: Capture Planning & Competitive Analysis (Questions 6-10)

Question 6 (Scenario)

You're developing a capture plan for a \$20M opportunity. Your primary competitor is the 5-year incumbent with strong customer relationships but aging technology. Your company has innovative technology but no direct experience with this customer. What should be your primary win theme?

- A. "We're cheaper than the incumbent"
- B. "Our modern technology platform reduces risk and improves outcomes while our cleared team ensures seamless transition"
- C. "The incumbent has been there too long"
- D. "We have the best employees in the industry"

Your Answer:

Question 7 (Analysis)

In a competitive analysis, you've identified that your main competitor's weakness is high staff turnover on their current contract. How should you leverage this in your capture strategy?

- A. Mention their turnover directly in your proposal
- B. Emphasize your retention strategy, staff stability metrics, and commitment to continuity as ghost themes
- C. Try to recruit their employees before the proposal is due
- D. Ignore it—you can't prove their turnover rate

Your Answer:

Question 8 (Scenario)

Your capture team is preparing for a Gate 2 review (mid-capture decision point). Which deliverable is MOST important to present?

- A. Complete draft proposal
- B. Updated competitive analysis, refined win themes, customer engagement summary, and preliminary solution approach
- C. Final pricing
- D. Signed teaming agreements only

Your Answer:

Question 9 (Application)

You're creating a "ghosting" strategy against an incumbent. Ghosting means:

- A. Ignoring the competition entirely
- B. Highlighting your strengths in areas where competitors are weak, without naming them
- C. Spreading negative information about competitors
- D. Copying the competitor's approach

Your Answer:

Question 10 (Scenario)

You need a teaming partner with specific technical expertise. You've identified two options: Company A has the exact skills but is a direct competitor on other work; Company B has 80% of the skills needed but is not a competitor. Which is the better teaming choice?

- A. Always choose the most technically qualified partner regardless of competitive concerns
- B. Choose Company B—the strategic risk of teaming with a competitor often outweighs the capability gap
- C. Team with both companies
- D. Don't use a teaming partner; do everything in-house

Your Answer:

Section C: Stakeholder Engagement & Customer Intelligence (Questions 11-15)

Question 11 (Scenario)

You have a meeting scheduled with the Program Manager (government) for a potential \$15M opportunity. The Contracting Officer is not attending. What topics are appropriate to discuss?

- A. Pricing strategy and competitors' weaknesses
- B. Mission challenges, capability gaps, and how your company might address their needs
- C. Evaluation criteria and scoring methodology
- D. Specific proposal content recommendations

Your Answer: ☐

Question 12 (Analysis)

You're mapping stakeholders for a large agency opportunity. You've identified: the Contracting Officer, the Program Manager, the End Users, and the CIO's office. Who is typically the MOST important to influence during capture?

- A. Contracting Officer only—they make the award decision
- B. Program Manager and End Users—they define requirements and evaluate technical merit
- C. CIO only—they control the budget
- D. Focus equally on all stakeholders

Your Answer: ☐

Question 13 (Scenario)

During an industry day, a government official mentions they're "looking for innovative approaches to reduce help desk costs by 20%." How should you use this information?

- A. Ignore it—industry days are just formalities
- B. Document it as a customer hot button and develop a solution that specifically addresses the 20% cost reduction target
- C. Wait until the RFP to see if it's mentioned
- D. Assume all competitors heard the same thing, so it's not valuable

Your Answer:

Question 14 (Application)

Which of the following is an appropriate customer engagement activity AFTER an RFP is released?

- A. One-on-one meetings with the Program Manager to discuss your approach
- B. Submitting formal questions through the designated Q&A process
- C. Calling the Contracting Officer to discuss evaluation criteria
- D. Sending your draft proposal for feedback

Your Answer:

Question 15 (Scenario)

Your company currently performs as a subcontractor on a contract. The prime contractor relationship has soured, and you're considering pursuing the recompile as the prime. What risk should you evaluate first?

- A. Whether you can undercut the current prime's price
- B. Whether your subcontractor past performance can be claimed as prime past performance and potential Organizational Conflict of Interest (OCI) issues
- C. Whether the government likes your employees better
- D. The color scheme for your proposal

Your Answer:

Section D: Advanced Proposal Support & Execution (Questions 16-20)

Question 16 (Scenario)

You're conducting a compliance review of a draft proposal. You find that Section L requires a "Staffing Plan with labor categories and FTEs" but the current draft only lists labor categories without FTE counts. What should you do?

- A. Submit as-is—evaluators probably won't notice
- B. Flag it immediately as a compliance gap requiring correction before submission
- C. Add the FTEs to the cost volume only
- D. Wait to see if competitors include FTEs

Your Answer:

Question 17 (Analysis)

An RFP evaluation criteria states: "Technical Approach (40%), Past Performance (30%), Price (30%)—Best Value Tradeoff." What does this tell you about your proposal strategy?

- A. Price is most important—bid as low as possible
- B. Technical and Past Performance together outweigh price; a strong technical solution can justify higher pricing
- C. All three factors are equal
- D. Past Performance doesn't matter if your technical approach is strong

Your Answer:

Question 18 (Scenario)

Your team has won a contract. During the post-award debrief, the Contracting Officer mentions your proposal scored lower on "Understanding of Requirements" than the other finalist. What should you do with this feedback?

- A. Ignore it—you won anyway
- B. Document it as a lessons learned and improve how you demonstrate requirements understanding in future proposals
- C. Protest the evaluation
- D. Ask for re-scoring

Your Answer:

Question 19 (Application)

You're briefing the delivery team after a contract win. Which artifact from capture is MOST valuable to share?

- A. The competitor analysis
- B. The proposal executive summary, key commitments, and customer hot buttons identified during capture
- C. The bid/no-bid decision memo
- D. Internal pricing worksheets

Your Answer:

Question 20 (Scenario)

A protest has been filed against your contract award. The protester claims the agency didn't properly evaluate past performance. Your role as BD support is to:

- A. Contact the protester and negotiate a settlement
- B. Support legal/contracts by providing capture documentation that demonstrates your past performance qualifications
- C. Start looking for the next opportunity—this contract is lost
- D. Call the Contracting Officer to lobby for your award

Your Answer:

Answer Key

For Facilitator/Self-Grading Use Only

Q	Answer	Rationale
1	C	Yellow flag with mitigation strategy—realistic assessment
2	B	Leverage 8(a) status proactively for sole-source
3	B	No customer relationship + short timeline = lowest Pwin
4	B	Long tenure + mediocre satisfaction = opportunity
5	B	Customer relationship drives Pwin more than other factors
6	B	Win theme should be differentiated and benefit-focused
7	B	Ghost competitor weakness through your strength
8	B	Gate 2 requires capture strategy, not final proposal
9	B	Ghosting = highlighting your strengths vs their weaknesses
10	B	Strategic risk of competitor teaming often outweighs gaps
11	B	Mission-focused discussions are appropriate pre-RFP
12	B	Technical evaluators have most influence on merit
13	B	Customer hot buttons should drive solution design
14	B	Only formal Q&A is appropriate after RFP release
15	B	Past performance claims and OCI are critical risks
16	B	Compliance gaps must be corrected before submission
17	B	Best value means technical strength can offset price
18	B	Debriefs inform continuous improvement
19	B	Customer expectations and commitments guide delivery
20	B	BD supports protest defense with capture documentation

Scoring:

- 18-20 correct: Excellent—ready for Professional level
- 15-17 correct: Pass—review missed areas
- Below 15: Additional study required before advancing